

Yifei Zhang

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Education

B.Sc. in Computer Science and Technology (FinTech) <i>Department of Computer Science and Technology, Top Talent Class</i>	Nanjing University <i>Sep 2020 – Jun 2024</i>
M.Sc. in FinTech and Financial Engineering <i>School of Management & Engineering, supervised by Prof. Honghai Yu</i>	Nanjing University <i>Sep 2024 – Jun 2027</i>

Intern Experience

School of Data Science, CUHK-Shenzhen <i>Research intern advised by Prof. Benyou Wang</i>	<i>Jun 2024 – Mar 2025</i>
ML Group, Microsoft Research Asia (MSRA) <i>Research intern advised by Weiqing Liu and Xiao Yang</i>	<i>May 2025 – Jan 2026</i>

Research & Projects

UCFE Benchmark <i>Advised by Prof. Benyou Wang, Prof. Honghai Yu, and Jimin Huang</i> * Designed UCFE Benchmark, a user-centric financial expertise evaluation framework addressing limitations of existing benchmarks in dynamic interaction and multi-turn dialogue. * Led survey of 804 participants and constructed dataset with 330 entries across 17 task types; achieved strong human alignment (Pearson 0.78) using GPT-4o simulator and LLM-AS-JUDGE.	<i>Aug 2024 – Jan 2025</i> <i>Project Leader</i>
TwinMarket <i>Advised by Prof. Benyou Wang, Prof. Honghai Yu</i> * Led development of TwinMarket, a BDI-based multi-agent framework using LLMs to simulate investor behavior and social interactions in A-stock financial markets. * Scaled to 1,000+ agents, successfully replicating key financial phenomena (fat-tailed returns, volatility clustering) and emergent social dynamics (information cascades, opinion leaders).	<i>Oct 2024 – Mar 2025</i> <i>Project Leader</i>
RD-Agent(12,000 + GitHub stars) <i>Advised by Weiqing Liu and Xiao Yang</i> * MLE: Reframed automated ML engineering from tree search to gradient-based optimization, achieving 35.1% medal rate (SOTA) under closed-world protocol. * MLE: Designed scaling experiments demonstrating that gradient-based methods increasingly outperform tree search as model reasoning capability improves. * Finetune: Formulated autonomous LLM fine-tuning as joint optimization over data processing and training configuration, extending AutoML to the LLM era.	<i>May 2025 – Jan 2026</i> <i>Core Contributor</i>
AI-Trader (12,000+ GitHub Stars) <i>Collaboration with HKUDS Lab, HKU</i> * Led development of A-share market module, extending the LLM-based trading agent framework to support Chinese equity markets with T+1 settlement, $\pm 10\%$ price limits, and market-specific trading rules.	<i>Nov 2025 – Jan 2026</i> <i>Project Leader</i>

Publications

UCFE: A User-Centric Financial Expertise Benchmark for Large Language Models <i>NAACL Findings 2025</i>
TwinMarket: A Scalable Behavioral and Social Simulation for Financial Markets <i>NeurIPS 2025 & Best Paper Award in Financial AI @ ICLR 2025</i>
Reasoning as Gradient: Scaling MLE Agents Beyond Tree Search <i>ACL Findings 2026</i>
FT-Dojo: Towards Autonomous LLM Fine-Tuning with Language Agents <i>ICML 2026</i>

Honors & Awards

China National Scholarship for Master's Students, Nanjing University (top 0.2%)	<i>Oct 2025</i>
National Gold Award , China International College Students' Innovation Competition	<i>Oct 2025</i>
Outstanding Graduate Pacesetter , Nanjing University	<i>Nov 2025</i>